



August 25, 1930 at *Shishin-kaku*, Mt. Minobu before departure to India on the mission of *Saiten-kaikyō*.

Dharma rain into the stream of the Ganges.

If this Dharma is not returned to the Western Heavens, the prophecy of our great founder becomes smeared in mud. If this Dharma is not returned to the Western Heavens, our Bodhisattva practice will not hold true. If this Dharma is not returned to the Western Heavens, living beings of this *sahā* world will long be condemned to the gaol of strife and bloodshed. Therefore devas and good protector kings who lend power to the long-cherished aspiration of our great founder, may you graciously grant protection and guard over our practice.

Na Mu Myō Hō Ren Ge Kyō
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Gyōshō,
Keibyaku [With humility]²⁵

25 敬白. A term used at the end of a written petition to a deity or Buddha. In this case, it is a petition to Nichiren Daishōnin and protector deities.

2

DISPERSE THE GLOOM OF THE LIVING

January 7, 1951

Excerpt from *World War III*
Kobe Buddhist Association Hall, Japan

CHAPTER XXI OF THE LOTUS SŪTRA, *The Divine Transcendental Powers of the Tathāgata*, says:

Just as the light of the sun and moon
Dispel the darkness,
So this person where he goes about in practice,
Shall disperse the gloom of the living

Darkness, once exposed to the light of the sun and moon, cannot but vanish. Darkness also exists in people's collective life on earth, as well as in the hearts and minds of each human. Such darkness is hard to expel, even with the light of the sun and moon.

Only those compassionate individuals who take on hardship and suffering through their invaluable sacrifice of blood and tears can dispel the darkness in society and in the hearts and minds of human beings. Those who stepped up to sacrifice themselves in this way would be India and her people—the country that gave birth to Buddha Śākyamuni, Nagarjuna¹ and Vasubandhu;² and Japan and her people, who received the teachings left by the Tathāgata and who uphold the True Dharma in the Era of Final Dharma as the great light for people afflicted by

1 Nāgārjuna is one of the chief philosophers of Mahāyāna Buddhism and the founder of Mādhyamika School. He was born in a Brāhmana family in South India around the 2nd or 3rd century.

2 Vasubandhu was born in Purusapura of Gāndhāra in the 5th century. He studied Theravāda and criticized Mahāyāna but later converted to Mahāyāna.

the five pollutions.³

India's noble mission is to reject war on earth and to protect the lives of the people. The noble mission of Japan is likewise to reject war on earth and to protect the lives of the people. The precept against taking life, which is practiced through nonviolence and nonresistance, deters evil. The practice of *tangyō-raihai* [the sole practice of bowing in veneration to the Buddha in others] is the precept that creates good.

Take not life even at the expense of giving up your own life. Venerate out on the streets rather than worshipping in temples and monasteries. Venerate fellow human beings instead of Buddha statues.

The act of killing the wicked does nothing to stop their ignoble minds. Bowing towards and reverence offered to wicked people has the power to transform their wicked minds. This religion that focuses solely on the practice of veneration toward others is what will bring emancipation to the Era of Final Dharma.

3

WONDROUS FIRST CONNECTION WITH LORD BUDDHA'S RELIC

Busshari-engi¹

September 1, 1933

ONE HUNDRED YEARS AFTER BUDDHA'S PARINIRVĀNA, Ashoka the Great came into this world and united the *Jambudvīpa* [world]. He built 84,000 stūpas² and widely disseminated the Buddha Dharma. His son, Prince Mahinda, was ordained a bhikshu and traveled to Ceylon³ to spread the Dharma. In the outskirts of the then royal capital of Anuradhapura⁴ stands Mount Mihintale,⁵ a notable, solitary peak where, according to legend, the Preceptor Buddha Śākyamuni visited and delivered the

1 仏舍利縁起. *Wondrous First Connection with Lord Buddha's Relic* was first published in September 1933 as a booklet. This is a translation based on the text reintroduced in 一閻浮提 *Ichien-budai* [*Jambudvīpa*] published by 大法輪閣 Daihōrinkaku in August 1972. Guruji arrived in Colombo in May 1932 from Bombay, and made extensive pilgrimages throughout Ceylon initially with the Maha Bodhi Society offering its *vihara* as his home base. He later practiced out of a cave he found midway up Sri Pada, a sacred mountain known for Buddha's footprint, in the summer of 1932. August 23 of that year, after the daily prayer service at sunrise at the peak of Sri Pada, he stopped by a waterfall to bathe, as was his custom, on his way down to the cave dōjō. There he found a ring with three gemstones and rejoiced that it could be an auspicious omen for his mission of *Saiten-kaikyō*.

2 The number 84 is quite common in Indian numerology, occurring either alone or as 84,000 or 840,000. It is seen in Buddhist as well as Hindu and Jain traditions. Some sources say it indicates a large, imprecise number while others say it has mystical connotations. According to the *Asokavadana* [*Annals of Ashoka*], King Ashoka opened ten of the original stūpas, divided these relics and vowed to erect 84,000 stūpas.

3 Former name for Sri Lanka until 1972. At the time Guruji wrote these entries, Ceylon was a colony under British rule which stretched from 1815 to 1948.

4 First historic capital of Sri Lanka, located 128 miles from Colombo, the current capital.

5 During the Poson season [June], thousands of devotees ascend the 1,840 stone steps to the top of the Mihintale hill to pay their respects to Arahāt Mahinda, whose relics are said to be enshrined in the Ambasthala stūpa. This stūpa was created by King Mahadathika Mahanaga on flat land just below the peak where Mahinda and the king were supposed to have met and talked.

3 Panca Kāṣāyah. The five pollutions of the present world are: i) a period of war, natural disasters, pestilence; ii) a period in which heresies flourish; iii) a period in which passion is strong; iv) a period in which people are physically and mentally weak; v) a period in which the life span is short.